Example Panhandle University Medical Center

Financial Assistance Program Policy

Effective date: February 1, 2026

1. Purpose

Example Panhandle University Medical Center is committed to providing financial assistance to patients who are uninsured, underinsured, or otherwise unable to pay for emergency and other medically necessary care, consistent with Section 501(r) of the Internal Revenue Code and applicable Texas law.

2. Scope

This Policy applies to emergency and other medically necessary care provided by Example Panhandle University Medical Center.

This Policy does not cover investigational treatments.

A list of providers who deliver care in the Hospital, showing which providers are and are not covered by this Policy, is in Appendix A of this Policy.

3. Definitions

3.1 Household. For purposes of this Policy, the household includes the patient and all individuals listed on the patient's most recent federal tax return.

3.2 Income. Household income means the household's total gross annual income before taxes and deductions.

3.3 Federal Poverty Guidelines (FPG). Eligibility is determined using the 2026 Federal Poverty Guidelines shown in the table in Section 4.

3.4 Medically necessary care. Care that is reasonable and necessary to diagnose or treat an illness or injury, as determined by the treating provider.

4. Eligibility for Financial Assistance

4.1 Patients may qualify for financial assistance if household income is at or below 500% of the FPG and the other conditions of this Policy are met.

Patients with household income at or below 200% of the Federal Poverty Guidelines qualify for free care, a 100% discount.

Household income above 200% and up to 300% of the Federal Poverty Guidelines: 80% discount (sliding scale).

Household income above 300% and up to 400% of the Federal Poverty Guidelines: 60% discount (sliding scale).

Household income above 400% and up to 500% of the Federal Poverty Guidelines: 40% discount (sliding scale).

2026 Federal Poverty Guidelines income limits (annual household income):

Household size	100%	200%	300%	400%	500%
1	$15,650	$31,300	$46,950	$62,600	$78,250
2	$21,150	$42,300	$63,450	$84,600	$105,750
3	$26,650	$53,300	$79,950	$106,600	$133,250
4	$32,150	$64,300	$96,450	$128,600	$160,750
5	$37,650	$75,300	$112,950	$150,600	$188,250
6	$43,150	$86,300	$129,450	$172,600	$215,750
7	$48,650	$97,300	$145,950	$194,600	$243,250
8	$54,150	$108,300	$162,450	$216,600	$270,750

5. Other Eligibility Conditions

5.1 Assets. The Hospital does not consider assets when determining eligibility.

5.2 Residency. Patients must be residents of the State of Texas. The residency requirement does not apply to emergency care.

5.3 Insurance. Insured patients are eligible for assistance with deductibles, co-insurance and other balances after insurance.

5.4 Other programs. Patients are not required to apply for Medicaid before receiving a financial assistance determination.

6. How to Apply

6.1 Application period. Patients may apply at any time within 240 days after the date of the first post-discharge billing statement.

6.2 Required documents. Applicants must attach the following documents:

(a) the prior year federal tax return;

(b) two recent pay stubs;

(c) Social Security benefit statements, if applicable;

6.3 Where to apply. Completed applications may be submitted:

- By mail to Financial Assistance Program, 1600 Example Wallace Blvd, Amarillo, TX 79106.

- By fax to (806) 555-0799.

- Online at https://mychart.examplepanhandleumc.example/assistance.

6.4 Determination. The Hospital will notify the patient in writing of its determination and the basis for the determination.

6.5 Award period. Approved financial assistance applies to eligible care for 12 months from the date of determination.

7. Billing and Collections

7.1 Amounts generally billed (AGB). The Hospital calculates amounts generally billed using the look-back method based on Medicare fee-for-service and all private health insurers. The current AGB percentage is 27.4% of gross charges.

7.2 Presumptive eligibility. The Hospital does not make presumptive eligibility determinations; an application is required.

7.3 Screening. The Hospital screens patients for financial assistance before issuing the first billing statement.

7.4 Refunds. Overpayments by approved patients will be refunded within 30 days.

7.5 Collections. The Hospital will not engage in extraordinary collection actions before making reasonable efforts to determine whether a patient is eligible for financial assistance. The Billing and Collections Policy is available free of charge.

Questions: call (806) 555-0700 or write to Financial Assistance Program, 1600 Example Wallace Blvd, Amarillo, TX 79106.